The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Glorious Jambhala

Āryajambhalaśrīnāmadhāraṇī · Toh 973 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་གནོད་སྦྱིན་གྱི་བདག་པོ་དཔལ་ཛམ་བྷ་ལ་ཞེས་བྱ་བའི་གཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Glorious Jambhala, given in Sanskrit as Ārya Jambhala Śrī Nāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan under a title that begins Phakpa Nö, referring to the noble lord of the yakṣas, is a short dhāraṇī scripture devoted to Jambhala, the king of the yakṣas, a deity long associated with wealth and prosperity. It opens in the celestial abode of Alakāvatī, where Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, is surrounded by a retinue of yakṣas and asks Jambhala to teach his own life-essence and vidyā-mantra so that the poverty and suffering of beings may be pacified, promising to add his own blessing. Jambhala agrees, presenting the mantra and its practice for those who wish to abandon suffering, attain happiness, and complete the two great accumulations of merit and wisdom. The work is Toh 973 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the collection of dhāraṇī texts, short works centered on the recitation of sacred formulas.

In the language of India: ārya jambhala śrī nāma dhārattvi. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Glorious Jambhala.

Homage to the king of the yakṣas, glorious Jambhala.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One, glorious Vajrapāṇi, was dwelling in the sublime abode of Alakāvatī, surrounded by a retinue of many yakṣas. At that time the Lord of Secrets said to the king of the yakṣas, glorious Jambhala: "To pacify the poverty and suffering of those sentient beings, teach your own life-essence and vidyā-mantra! I too shall bless them."

Then glorious Jambhala replied:

"Blessed One, Lord of Secrets,
to pacify the suffering of beings
I shall teach the vidyā-mantra.
Those who would abandon suffering and gain happiness,
who wish to complete the two great accumulations,
should, to protect their own bodies, recite
this vidyā-mantra and hold it fully:

nama ārya jambhala mahā jambhala tadyathā ra ra ra ra ku nu ku nu khu nu khu nu gu nu gu nu sa pa sa pa ka ra ka ra mahā bi ra ram mahā ka ra do ma ra ṣa ha ra ṣa du ma sarba sva tvā nā na ca svāhā"

"Blessed One, Lord of Secrets, if, while reciting this mantra, one enchants a blue thread with the mantra seven times, tying one knot each time, and binds it on the upper arm, there will be no harm, and one's aims will be accomplished.

Guggulu, sandalwood, turuṣka,
and a medicine compounded with katara:
with these one should present offerings.

nama ārya jambhala namo dantāya danti śva rā ya ākarṣaya a ka ra mi ta dan ti śva rā ya ba ra ma ka rdu ni ya sarba sa tva hi ta ji ta ma ma da na ta namaḥ p ri ya śa sa ma ya ā ka ra śa svāhā

One should recite this vidyā-mantra a full seven times, and after that recite the secret essence. Moreover, if one first makes offerings to the noble Three Jewels and to the Lord of Secrets, Vajrapāṇi, and after that recites my name, I will bring about wealth and whatever is wished for, and bestow happiness. Then, if one recites this secret mantra of mine, the wish-fulfilling jewel, and holds it as one's sacred commitment, I will accomplish all the aims that person names."

Then the king of the yakṣas, glorious Jambhala, offered his own essence, which is like a wish-fulfilling jewel, to glorious Vajrapāṇi:

nama ārya jambhala mahā jambhala tadyathā si mi si mi su mu su mu ścaṇḍa ścaṇḍa ca ra ca ra sa ra sa ra ka ra ka ra ki ri ki ri ku ru ku ru mu ru mu ru cu ru cu ru sad ya da ma ma ma ni da ma a na na ta dānte svāhā ārya jambhala svāhā dantāya svāhā ma nor tha pa ri pū ra kā ya svāhā

Then, at that time, the members of the retinue of the yakṣa, glorious Jambhala, each spoke their own essence:

oṃ jambhala ma ṇi bha dā ya svāhā
oṃ jambhala pū rṇa bha drā ya svāhā
oṃ jambhala dan dā ta bha dṭā ya svāhā
oṃ jambhala mahā da na dā ta bha drā ya svāhā
oṃ jambhali ci bi kuṇḍali svāhā
oṃ jambhala ki li mā li ni svāhā
oṃ jambhala mu khendra bha drā ya svāhā
oṃ jambhala ja lendra bha drā ya svāhā

Then the Lord of Secrets said: "Lord of Wealth, you must grant happiness, just as they wish, to all those who hold, keep, write, and read this dhāraṇī!"

Then Jambhala replied, "Lord of Secrets, I shall do so," and, having properly circumambulated him three times, he sat down.

This completes The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Glorious Jambhala.

Translator's Notes

- The offering substance □□□□□ is not securely identifiable. It is given here as "katara," following the Tibetan spelling. Vajrapāṇi is called "the Blessed One" in this text. The phrase rendered "holds it as one's sacred commitment" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) may also mean taking the mantra as one's chosen deity practice. In "this secret mantra of mine," the Tibetan has bdag gis, "by me," with the verb "recite." This is read here as Jambhala's mantra recited by the practitioner. A reading "if I recite" seems unlikely in context.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.